

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 4

♥ Q J 9

♦ K 9 5 2

♣ 9 3

♠ K 9 3

♥ A 7 6 5 4

♦ J 8

♣ Q 7 4



♠ J 7 6 5 2

♥ 3

♦ 10 6 4

♣ A K 10 5

♠ A

♥ K 10 8 2

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ J 8 6 2

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♣ A

[showcards W:CA N:C2]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣ A, dummy played the ♣ 2

Play the ♣ 3.

If you signal with the ♣ 9 East will continue with the ♣ K and another which you will have to ruff. You will give up your NATURAL trump trick by doing so. Worse, you will allow South's ♣ J to be established as a winner that North can later discard a ♦ on.

Much better to play low. Partner will surely switch to a ♦, and North will probably finesse, though it doesn't matter whether he does or not. You will win the ♦ K, return the ♣ 9 back to East's ♣ K, and still have your trump trick for later.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K Q 10 7

♥ 10 9

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K 8 4

♠ J 6 4 2

♥ J 6 3

♦ A J 6

♣ 10 7 3



♠ 9 3

♥ 5 4

♦ Q 10 8 3

♣ J 9 6 5 2

♠ 8 5

♥ A K Q 8 7 2

♦ K 5 4

♣ A Q

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

2 ♥

Pass

1 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

Lead: ♠ A

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠ A, East plays the ♠ 9, South the ♠ 5. You assume East has signaled you to continue ♠ s, so you play the ♠ Q. On this trick East plays the ♠ 3 and South the ♠ 8. How will you continue?

You know that both East and South are now void of ♠ s. You might just switch suits, but you have a better choice.

If you play your ♠ Q, East won't bother ruffing, South **WILL** ruff and dummy's ♠ J will be established as a winner.

The best procedure is to lead a low ♠ . East will ruff and South will over-ruff but by playing this way you stop the establishment of North's ♠ J. As you can see, South would have been able to discard a loser on that ♠ J if you hadn't played this way.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 10 5 2
♥ 8 5 3
♦ A 7 3
♣ J 6 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ J 6

♣ A K Q 10 4



♠ K 9 6 3

♥ Q J 10 7

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 8 3

♠ J 8

♥ 9 6 2

♦ K Q 10 9 4

♣ 9 7 5

West	North	East	South
	2NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥Q

Only by watching what East plays. On the ♦J East played the ♦2, a low card signaling that he held an ODD number of ♦s. ODD must be either one or three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that North started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

This defense holds North to one ♦ tricks, if you had let him win the second one he would have had 9 tricks.

[showcards S:DJ W:D2 N:D4]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥Q, you played low and North won the ♥A.

North now plays the ♦J on which East plays the ♦2. What do you play now, and what is your plan.

Play the ♦3 and when North plays another ♦ win with your ♦A.

South hoped his ♦ suit would provide enough tricks to make the game. You can see that there is no entry to the South hand EXCEPT in ♦s, so you want to win your ♦A on the trick that North plays his last ♦. How can you tell which trick that is?

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 6 5
 ♥ Q 10 6 4
 ♦ K 7 2
 ♣ 10 5 2

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 8 7

♦ Q 6 5

♣ 9 7 6 4



♠ 8 7 2

♥ J 9 5 2

♦ A 8 4 3

♣ 8 3

♠ J 10 4

♥ A K 3

♦ J 10 9

♣ A K Q J

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥ 4			

[showcards S:ST]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥ 4, East plays the ♥ J, won by South with ♥ A.

South plays the ♠ J, you follow with ♠ 5, dummy ♠ 3 and East plays the ♠ 2. South continues with the ♠ 10

Play the ♠ 6.

East's ♠ 2 tells you he had an ODD number of ♠ s, obviously 3. Since South also must have 3, you must take your ♠ A on the third round, depriving dummy of the extra ♠ trick.

South may now turn to the ♦ suit, but your side can win the first ♦ and drive out South's ♥ K. You will win 2 ♥ s, 2 ♦ s and the ♠ A, down 1